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ISLAMIC STUDIES for CSS

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Introduction to Islam

● **Important Terms**

- (1) **Mazhab/Religion**
- (2) **Deen**
- (3) **Shariah**
- (4) **Ideology**

● **Religion, ETYMOLOGY**

RELIGION:

- Derived from a **old French word** “*reliun*” which means “*Respect for what is sacred*”
- Derived from a **Latin root word** “*Religionem*” which means “*Reverence for the gods*”

● **MAZHAB**

● **An Arabic word**

Literal Meaning:

- Way to go
  - Style
- School of thought/Sect

● **DEEN**

● **An Arabic word**

**Literal Meaning:**

- Retaliation
- Commandment
- Judgment

- **Shariah**

- **An Arabic word literally, “the path leading to the watering place”**

- Means Islamic law
- Composed of Commandments, rules, regulation, practices and morals that are designed by Allah to protect and benefit all of humankind
- Includes beliefs as well practices e.g. ways of worship, principles of social life, rules of mutual relations & dealings, halal & haram, legitimate & illegitimate etc.

**MAZHAB vs. DEEN**

- **FIRST VIEW POINT**

**Deen is a totality and Mazhab/Religion is a part of it**

- DEEN is a **comprehensive** term than MAZHAB because DEEN is the name of Mazhab/religion which has its connection with all aspects of human life

WHEREAS

- MAZHAB is not related to every aspect of human life but to some or to most

- **SECOND VIEW POINT**

- DEEN is the name of the principles/beliefs which remained **common** among teachings of all revealed religions and were the parts of the teachings of every Prophet and Messenger e.g. **Oneness of Allah**

WHEREAS

- MAZHAB is the name of the practical aspects found in the shariahs of Prophets and Messengers

## ● WESTERN DEFINITIONS OF “RELIGION”

- “Belief in spiritual beings”  
(Edward Burnett Taylor)
- “Relation of a man [follower] with some holy [founder] person  
(Encyclopedia of Britannica)

(3) The term religion whatever its definition be, clearly refers to certain  
CHARACTERISTICS, BELIEFS, PRACTICES, FEELINGS and  
ATTITUDES

(Encyclopedia of Ethics)

## ● Continued...

(4) “Religion is the name of the beliefs and a power that give a man internal  
purity and cleanliness”

(A. N. Whitehead)

(5) “People's beliefs and opinions concerning the existence, nature, and worship  
of a deity or deities, and divine involvement in the universe and human life”

(Encyclopedia of Encarta)

## ● AN ANALYSIS OF WESTERN DEFINITIONS

Western scholars somehow interpret religion as:

- something related to thought only, not stressing upon the practical aspect
- the name of some religious rituals only, not beyond
- a personal matter of every individual

## ● Quranic Guidance

الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتْمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا

“This day, I have perfected your religion for you, completed my favor [religion of  
Islam] upon you and have chosen for you Islam as your religion”

(Al-Maeda 5:03)

● إِنَّ الدِّينَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ الْإِسْلَامُ

“Truly, the [accepted] religion with Allâh is Islâm [only] ”  
(Imran 3:19)

(Al-e-

● وَمَنْ يَبْتَغِ غَيْرَ الْإِسْلَامِ دِينًا فَلَنْ يُقْبَلَ مِنْهُ وَهُوَ فِي الْآخِرَةِ مِنَ الْخَسِرِينَ

“And whoever seeks a religion other than Islâm, it will never be accepted of him,  
and in the Hereafter he will be one of the losers”  
(Al-e-Imran 3:85)

## ● Ideology

● Ideology is a **set of beliefs, principles, values, images, assumptions**, and/or **expectations** that **govern, organize, control, design, simplify**, and **give meaning to our actions**, which otherwise would get side-tracked and unfocused.

## ● ISLAMIC DEFINITION OF *Deen*

“A divine, universal and a complete system of life based on the directions revealed by the Almighty Allah, to worldly creatures (humans & Jinn) time to time to make them His true slaves and to help them succeed in here and in hereafter”

## ● Islam as an Ideology

Islam is not a mere Mazhab/Religion but rather it is a Deen as well as a powerful Ideology

## ● Need for Religion

What is the need for Religion?

whether man can live happily without having faith in any religion?

## ● Having faith in God is demand of human mind

Name Him as God/ Allah/nature/human understanding etc.

NATURE is an essential quality or characteristic of some thing by which a thing is recognized and known. In case, if this characteristic is removed, then the particular thing is no more the same thing.

For instance, liquidity and flow  
For water

- Satisfaction of mind by answering a number of naturally raised questions:
  - Answers of What, Why, How, Where
    - Purpose of man's creation
    - Purpose of world's creation
  - Beginning and ending of worldly setup
    - Do humans have Free will or not?



## FUNDAMENTAL ELEMENTS OF RELIGION

- Faith & Beliefs: All of the existing creeds have some theoretical teachings called as faith
  - Traditions & Rituals
    - Ethics
  - **Structure of Islam**
- Beliefs (Aqaid)
- Worships (Ibadat)

- Social Affairs (Mu'amlat & Mu'ashrat)
- Rules and Laws (Hudood & Qawaneen)
- Ethics (Akhlaqiat)

- Importance of Deen

Islam as Deen assures/provides humans:

- a clear path of success
- Commandments about each and every matter of worldly life
- Sense of optimism even during all odds of life
- commitment of bright future